

boAt Watch Vertex

The boAt Watch Vertex is a new budget fitness tracker from boAt which comes with a decent number of features for its ₹2,499 price tag. Starting off with the contents of the box, in addition to the watch, we've got a magnetic 2-pin charging cable, the user manual, and a warranty card. Coming to the Vertex itself, we got the black and grey variant of the watch, with the main body of the watch being matte black and grey silicone straps. We found the overall build of the watch to be decent. The matte finish on both the silicone straps and the body of the watch look pretty good.

The watch has a 1.69-inch display, with a dial on the right side of the watch. This can be used to navigate through the watch, and pressed to immediately return to the previous menu or the home screen. Navigation

can otherwise be done via touch, since the watch features a touch screen. We found the display quality to be pretty good as well, and clearly visible at the right brightness even in daylight. The font and icons look clear and crisp.

The Vertex boasts all the typical features of a smartwatch or fitness tracker at this price range, including a step counter, heart rate monitor, calories burned, Spo2 monitor, and even sleep tracking. The watch features multiple activity modes, which tracks and records your steps, calories and BPM. The sleep tracker stores data for the previous 7 days, and can show you how much light



or deep sleep you've had. The watch also features a few QoL features, like a theatre mode which turns the brightness all the way down and turns off vibration, and a torch, which basically turns the watch face white and turns up the brightness. You can also

remotely control your music and camera apps via the boAt Watch Vertex, make and receive calls, and check your messages. The only qualm we had with the Vertex was with the UI, which we found to be sluggish and unresponsive at times.

Overall, a decent budget offering from boAt.

PRICE: ₹2,499

Sennheiser MKE 200 Directional Camera Microphone Kit

The Sennheiser MKE 200 is an all-in-one solution for upgrading the audio quality of your vlogs. Aimed at vloggers and influencers who like to record on the go, the MKE 200 kit comes with all the accessories that you'd want. In the box you'll find TRS and TRRS cables so that you can use the MKE 200 with your ILCs (Interchangeable Lens Cameras) and your smartphones. Then there's a windsock or deadcat for the microphone. Finally, there's the Manfrotto PIXI mini tripod along with a smartphone clamp for hands-free recording.

Getting a good mini tripod such as the Manfrotto PIXI is a huge boon for anyone shooting with a smartphone. The included clamp is just superb. It's machined from an aluminium block, allows you to pivot by 90 degrees and there's even a cold shot mount at the top.

As for the MKE 200 microphone, it's covered with a meshy wind-screen all around and on the inside

lies a condenser microphone placed on an internal shock mount. We didn't hear a lot of handling noise or vibrations travelling up into the microphone. The 3.5 mm jack is on the front of the mic and has a screwable ring to clamp the connector onto the mic tightly. The MKE 200 is a short barrel shotgun microphone so it's meant to only capture audio from the source sitting right in front of the mic and reduce any sound coming from off-axis. In our testing, we found that the mic does capture quite a bit of the audio

coming from off-axis in open environments. As for the audio quality, it is an immense upgrade over the default microphone present in smartphones and even some ILCs.

Considering the sheer value for money package that the kit is with all its included accessories, the Sennheiser MKE 200 is a no-brainer purchase for vloggers and influencers wanting to upgrade the production quality of their videos.

PRICE: ₹10,499

